Bill about our little stunt.'

'Bill?' said Bundle, annoyed.

'Well, after all,' said Jimmy, 'Bill is one of the lads, you know. Ronny was a pal of his and so was Gerry.'

'Oh! I know,' said Bundle.

'But you think it's a pity? Sorry.'

'That isn't that,' said Bundle. 'But he's—well, Bill's a born blunderer.'

'Not mentally very agile?' suggested Jimmy. 'But you forget one thing—Bill's got a very hefty fist. And I've an idea that a hefty fist is going to come in handy.'

'Well, perhaps you're right. How did he take it?'

'Well, he clutched his head a good bit, but—I mean the facts took some driving home. But by repeating the thing patiently in words of one syllable I at last got it into his thick head. And, naturally, he's with us to the death, as you might say.'

'I must make some introductions, Eileen. This is Sir Stanley Digby—Lady Eileen Brent. Mr O'Rourke.' The Air Minister was a little round man with a cheerful smile. Mr O'Rourke, a tall young man with laughing blue eyes and a typical Irish face, greeted Bundle with enthusiasm.

'And I thinking it was going to be a dull political party entirely,' he murmured in an adroit whisper.

'Hush,' said Bundle. 'I'm political—very political.'

Lady Coote, after [illegible] turned to Jimmy Thesiger, and appeared to be [illegible] something closely akin to pleasure. Despite his reprehensible habit of being late for breakfast, Lady Coote had a fondness for this amiable, pink-faced young man. His air of irrepressible good nature fascinated her. She had a motherly wish to cure him of his bad habits and form him into one of the world's workers. Whether, once formed, he would be as attractive was a question she had never asked herself. She began now to tell him of a very painful motor accident which had happened to one of her friends.

A serious, pale-faced young man bowed.

Bundle thought she was one of the most beautiful women she had ever seen. Her eyes were very large and blue, her hair was coal black, she had a matte skin, the slightly flattened nose of the Slav, and a sinuous, slender body. Her lips